



The land speed **record**

Ever since cars were invented, they've become faster and faster. This means people are constantly competing to see who can drive the **fastest**.

When Andy Green set the record, he went so fast he traveled faster than the speed of sound. This created an explosion called "a sonic boom."

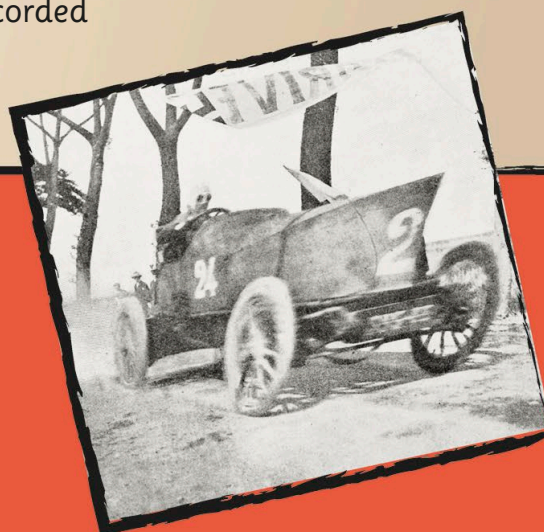
The challenge

People were racing long before the idea of a speed record came about, but the official speed record rules state that a car has to be driven on a **flat course** over 1 mile (previously 1km) in both directions. The time recorded would be the average top speed of **both times**.



Setting the pace

In 1898, Frenchman Gaston de Chasseloup-Laubat, drove an **electric car**, and reached **39.24mph (62.78kph)**. Ever since, people have continued to try and set a new record.



In 1904 France's Louis Rigolly became the first person to drive at more than 100mph.